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SIR V.S. NAIPAUL

78, Writer (14)

The Novel Touch

Because he is one of the world's most admired and most controversial authors, even though he has declared the novel dead.

Because last year, *The Times* ranked him seventh on their list of "The 50 greatest British writers since 1945".

Because he has joined a select band of living figures whose portraits hang in London's National Portrait Gallery.

Did you know He is visiting Africa, the theatre of much of his early writing, to research a new book.



PIYAL BHATTACHARJEE/www.indiatodayimages.com

KALYAN CHAKRAVORTY/www.indiatodayimages.com



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JAGDISH BHAGWATI

76, Economist (New)

Free Trade Guru

Because he is the world's pre-eminent globalisation buff and as University Professor at Columbia University and Senior Fellow in International Economics at the Council on Foreign Relations, his word resonates in world capitals.

Because he has been adviser to major global economic institutions and has authored or edited over 50 volumes.

Because he is a leader in the fight for freer trade.

Because as adviser to India's Finance Minister, now Prime Minister, he set the stage for the country's economic reforms.

Did you know His greatest failure is the lack of culinary skill. His wife, Padma, once asked him to make coffee. He put the kettle on and dashed back to ask her: "Darling, how do I know when the water is boiling?" She answered: "When it starts to look like champagne."

BANDEEP SINGH/www.indiatodayimages.com

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RAGHURAM RAJAN

47, Economist (New)

The Wizard

Because he is a globally admired economist, having been made the youngest Chief Economist at the IMF, becoming the first person from a developing country to hold the post.

Because he was one of the few economists to warn of the impending 2007-2008 collapse of the world's financial system.

Because the current Professor of Finance at Chicago University was appointed by Prime Minister Manmohan Singh to chair a committee on financial reforms and his recommendations were included in the finance minister's budget proposals.

Because he was the inaugural recipient of the Fischer Black Prize awarded by the American Finance Association for contributions to the theory and practice of finance by an economist under the age of 40.

Did you know Manmohan regularly refers to his speech "India—A Hub for Globalisation", where he laid out steps to be taken to make the country one of the top three economies in the world.

